

## Dancing Machaut's Chansons Baladees

### list of revisions

At the outset, I wish to thank my reviewers for their close reading of my work and many insightful comments, through which this study has been much improved.

#### Reviewer 1

-the text underlay in my transcription of V14 doesn't follow the note groupings in the MSS, e.g.. Vg 325v

-clarified that my interpretation of metric groupings in mm. 8 and 12, contra Ludwig's edition, derive from my own melodic and textual analysis and a desire to explore the ramifications of Leguy's flexible groupings, as metrical flexibility gains currency through the work of Maw et al. [17-9]

-added reference to how the MSS minim groupings support Ludwig/Schrade's continuation of iambic here [17-8, esp. n. 33], shifting the syllable "-re" one 8th note later than in my Example 9.

-changed attribution of agency for the rhythmic reading from Machaut to myself [18]

-retained reference to text declamation supporting my alternative metrical reading of m. 8, clarifying how the setting of a weak syllable on a weak beat works in both 6/8 (Ludwig) and 3/4 (Leguy's flexible edition and my Example 9).

-pattern of text accent, esp. when working against the interpretation of metrical change

-V5: revised reference to text setting of the single word "dame" on beat 2 (of 3/4) as supportive of my metrical reading. Added statement that natural text declamation of the lyric alone is here reshaped by Machaut's musical setting, explained in my melodic analysis to follow. [28-30]

-V5: added note that dual time signatures in Leguy's flexible edition may accurately convey the friction between grouping patterns in two layers composed by Machaut, lyric and melodic. [30]

-VV32 and 27 (Ex. 19): added a few sentences about how the melodic/rhythmic contradiction of the natural text declamation of the opening of each of these virelais supports my reading of their first measure as a pickup [47]. Added mention of pyrrhic settings in pickup measures in V27 relegated to right foot [49]. Removed reference to "the same logic" applying throughout V32, as in mm. 15-6.

- incorporate analysis of line length and declamation patterns throughout
  - Limited the annotation and discussion of weak/strong syllables only when aiding the interpretation of flexible grouping, not for every normative example after the first one. Line lengths now indicated by vertical stroke in every example.
  - musical Example 5ff updated with scansion markings, line endings conveyed by vertical stroke
  - Ensi va discussion: added discussion of natural poetic declamation in relation to musical setting [12 and n. 21]
  - added line endings to Ex. 7, added mention of these along with cadences being regularly tied to left foot downbeats [14-5]
  - added discussion of unequal line lengths as supportive of tonal plan in V2 and how the feminine line ending of the B section further supports my dance interpretation of the end of the B section; added line lengths to Ex. 8 [15-6]
  - V9: revised figure and added note comparing melodic articulation with text line breaks for tonal balance [20 n. 35]
  - V27: modified Ex. 10 and added note on how compellingly the line lengths accentuate the tonal plan for the song, also accentuated by flexible dance steps [24 n. 42]
  - V5: added discussion of poetic line lengths as reinforcing of tonal plan [29-30]
  - V20: added discussion of poetic line lengths and pace of declamation in relation to the musical setting in connection with dance steps returning on wrong foot [33-4]
  - V38: addressed the luxurious rate of text declamation in one passage, and the text it paints, as the cause of what seems an extraneously repeated phrase in the form of the refrain [38-9 n. 59]
- all virelai numberings updated to reflect Ludwig/Schrade when divergent [*passim*]
- Vv as plural of virelais simplified to V or spelled out [*passim*]
- corrected list of all “small details” exactly as suggested [*passim*]

## Reviewer 2

-revisions now place useful footnotes in body of text. So doing, I aimed not to interrupt the flow of the text too much and a few ideas I consider important are still in the notes.

Promoted from footnotes are:

- etymology of the term *carole* [1]
- Grocheio's contemporaneous characterization of the music of *carole* dancing [8]
- that Grocheio's general term *ductia* for dance music referred to the virelai for sung music [12]
- on retaining dance steps as an analytical model of complex song that may not have been danced in the 14<sup>th</sup> century [27]
- on the important imprint of dance on this genre of song, whether actually danced or not, esp. in my analytical extension of dance step notation [29]
- my interpretation of triple groupings as a special case against the normative backdrop of duple in this repertoire [42]
- concerning the conflation of carole with all social round dancing (including rondeau), its eventual equivalence with the virelai through Grocheio's *ductia* (per se)
  - new note on the use of the term *carole* both for the dance style and for the music that accompanied *carole* dancing. [1 n. 2]
  - clarification of introductory section to specify Machaut's virelais as the danced songs in question, rather than making broader claims about chansons in general, and the equivalence to him (and subsequent scholarship; e.g. Perraino 2011, 239) of the terms virelai and chanson baladee [5-7]
  - new paragraph on Grocheio's categories of secular vocal dances and the matching of the *ductia* with the virelai (the music) and the *carole* (the dance by which the music is sometimes also known). Also added discussion and references (McGee and Stevens) for how the 14<sup>th</sup>-c. *carole* pursued here perhaps crystallized out of a wider range of dances appropriate to each of the *formes fixes* before the term became attached to the virelai in particular c. 1300 [7-8]
  - revised my discussion of the general application of round dancing steps to the music of rondeaux, in the earliest instances, and to Machaut's virelais in particular. Added quote from Chaganti 1998 that the virelai replaced the rondeau as the accompaniment for caroling. Added reference to McGee 1989 on Grocheio's

definition of the rondeau and other dance forms. For a manageable and consistent corpus in this study, I limit myself to Machaut's virelais while the historical background necessarily references rondeaux. Using the alternation of L/R dance steps is sufficiently fundamental to parse grouping structures in the music of both of these lyric forms. [9 n. 17]

-reference to Machaut self-consciously and specifically preserving the virelai as the "danced song" of his time, not the rondeau, and where this connection came from for him [7, 7 n. 11, and 9 n. 17]

-clarified the linking of the *ductia* as Grocheio's general term for dance music with the sung virelai, now with more citations [7, and 7 n. 12]

-terminology revisions to clarify that the *carole* is a type of dance and that rondeau or virelai are lyric genres set to music and danced in this way [9 n. 17]

-clarify usage of 16<sup>th</sup>-c. theory and French Baroque dance concepts to my application

-revised introduction to state that I take inspiration and analogy from manual conducting motions described by later theorists [5-6]

-removed extraneous mention of *tactus* [7]

-revised paragraph comparing 14<sup>th</sup>- and 16<sup>th</sup>-c. conceptions of triple groupings. I hope to weaken the effect of jumping forward in time by better situating this brief excursus within my focus on *ars nova* music. [23-4]

-note revised to mention 16<sup>th</sup>-c. theory on motion and embodiment as elements of composition/interpretation as bolstering my approach to 14<sup>th</sup>-c. music [29 n. 48]

-moved mention of Baroque dance manuals with steps articulating various metrical levels to footnote and added a sentence distinguishing this practice from my dance-informed analyses of medieval music [34 n. 54]

-what is meant by bipedal dance groupings, many later dances in triple time (e.g. waltz)

-removed the term "bipedal dancers" and revised that sentence to more clearly state the aims of the paper. [2] I had meant that the binary grouping of the vast majority of carols was a consequence of its natural fit for alternating steps with each of two feet, now explicitly stated on [5 and 5 n. 9]. Matching duple meter with L-R alternation of steps is further elaborated into strong-weak metrical accent on [17].

-clarify how the dance steps in my analytical notation are being created, multiple possibilities for each song

-The analyses represent my own interpretation of each song and occasionally offer alternative approaches to passages within a song. The methodology I develop here may be used by analysts to represent their own metrical interpretations.

-rectify conflicting claims that certain patterns affected dancers after claiming that the lead set the dance steps

-removed reference to a dance falling to ruin because metrical irregularity might trip up the dancers. I believe this removes the contradiction.

-added acknowledgement that opening rests also complete mensural units, not only provide practical space to begin dancing [25, 26]

-added further explanation of “free rhythm” as a group of rhythmic values that add up to some mensural unit under examination; e.g. three minims add up to a semibreve (and so receive one step), their music notation is not limited to semibreves alone to mark the *tempus* level of mensuration [33]

-removed two statements that undermine my thesis: dancers possibly happy to ignore metrical play and that grouping irregularity suggests a song doesn’t dance well [35]. Retained other references to dancing ambiguous measures straight [e.g. 44] when made in direct comparison to the advantages of alternative, flexible metrical readings. Retained references where I recommend no dancing step be taken in anacrusic openings so that a hypermetrical downbeat may be marked by a strong left foot [e.g. 50].

-See expansion of paragraph concerning the virtual encoding of dance norms in this repertoire, whether actually danced or not, with reference to modern scholarship. Through “virtual dance steps,” I extend dance notation as an analytical tool to sophisticated music that may have evolved beyond suitability for the simple steps of the *carole*, such as through pervasive metrical play, triple meter, and polyphonic accompaniment. I do not have evidence to argue whether these songs were actually danced. I show instead that the *virelai* has roots in a practical dance genre and I retain those steps (virtually) as a methodology to ground metrical interpretation in more complex examples. [28] Removed wording of “virtual or actual” to avoid confusion; making a distinction is not my aim here. [36]

-Examples 14 and 17: R/L dance steps raised and Greek phrase labels lowered to clarify distinction between them; thanks for this suggestion [37 and 44]

-on dancing *maximodus*: removed an explicit reference to the effect of metrical ambiguity on dancing at this level, which far exceeds practicality. Clarified that *modus* and *maximodus* steps are reckoned here as virtual steps; an analytical tool modeled after practical dancing [33].

-added brief signposts, often in the form of topic sentences, to maintain reader focus on my central purpose: using a regular dance pattern to interpret metrical irregularity. I found adding these most helpful in the first half of the article, being more weighted with exposition than the dance-analytical discussions that follow. [17-8, 20, reworked a disruptive paragraph interpreting Machaut's *fin'amors* poetry into a brief reference on 21-22, 23, 27, 33, final reminder on 55]

-how I determine steps (and only those possibilities for steps) remains vague

-my three axioms for generating steps to a song is first given on [11], preceding Example 5 as the first with dance step notation, and reviewed in the conclusion [55-6]

-In revisions prompted by both reviewers, I have added further explanation (tonal and textual evidence) and stated advantages for any alternative groupings that I consider, alongside discussion of the implications/detriments of continuing to dance the same passage straight [*passim*, see esp. 18-21, 23-4, Ex. 10, 27 on dancing rests or not, 30-2, 37-8 on anacrustic interpretation, 39-40, 42-3, Ex. 17 compared to 16, 44-5, 48, 49-54]

-on meter vs mensuration

-paragraph addresses this important distinction and my criteria for interpreting meter in medieval music on [16-7], with reference to Boone and Maw. A bit more on grouping free rhythm (in mensural notation) into metrical units, also in response to previous feedback. [33-4 and n. 54]

-removed reference to pirouette as metaphor for melodic neighbor motion [31]

-revised abbreviations, hyphenated adjectives, incomplete sentences etc.

-Ludwig is still the best critical source, gradually being superseded by Boogaart et al. (motets) as the new complete edition comes out. I make reference to the various manuscripts and Schrade's edition for notable variants.